

ISLAMIC UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY (IUT)

ISLAMIAAT

Hum 4157/4137

A pair of hands is shown holding a small, green, translucent globe of the Earth. The globe is positioned in the center of the frame, with the hands cupping it from below and sides. The background is a soft, out-of-focus white. The text is overlaid on the image.

**What do you know about
Environment???**

What do you know about

Environmental Protection in Islam???

Outline: Environmental Protection In Islam

- Ibadaats
 - Environmental Protection In Islam
- Importance
- Environmental Approach of Quran
- Environmental Approach of Hadith/ Sunnah
- Environmental Sustainability in Islam
- Environment Protection and Resource Conservation
- The approach of Islam towards the use of natural resources
- Spreading Environmental Awareness
- Protection of environment is the duty of every Muslim
- Conclusion



Importance

- There is an inseparable relation between the environment and our soul. It will be great if Muslims in particular and the wider world in general learn from the Holy Scriptures, like the Holy Qur'an and Hadith, to try to wage an eco-friendly jihad (noble effort) to promote environmental balance and stability. This will be the true jihad to please God and ensure easy entry to heaven, in the existing world, not to speak of the hereafter. Thus, we can taste the bliss of heaven on this planet before we chance upon the eternal paradise.

Environment protection is an important aspect of Islam. Being stewards of the Earth, it is the responsibility of Muslims to care for the environment in a proactive manner. There is a definite purpose behind the creation of different species, be it plants or animals. Muslims are encouraged to reflect on the relationship between living organisms and their environment and to maintain the **ecological balance created by Allah.**

Protection of the environment is essential to Islamic beliefs and mankind has the responsibility to ensure safe custody of the environment.



Environmental Approach of Quran

The Holy Qur'an offers a completely integrated view of the universe, where the human soul and the environment, mind and matter are all part of one living, conscious whole. Therefore, it exhorts man to live a balanced, moderate and an eco-friendly life without causing any harm to nature.

It says, for instance: **“And do not commit abuse on the earth, spreading corruption.”** (Qur'an, 2:60),

and elsewhere: **“And do not desire corruption in the land. Indeed, God does not like corruptors.”** (Qur'an 28:77).

From the Qur'anic perspective, corruption on the earth is not confined to only political crimes, such as frauds, theft, rape, illegal banking or other prevalent malpractices. Deforestation, dumping toxic wastes and indiscriminate use of pesticides are also grave corruption on the earth and hence brazen violation of Islamic values. This corruption is today rampant at all levels of public and social life in this age of consumerism and covetousness. It is indeed a matter of grave concern for the entire human kind.

He (Allah) created everything and determined them in exact proportions (25: 2).

The human community is but an infinitesimal part of the natural world but we have now lost sight of this through our proclivity for dominating it. The Qur'an observes:

لَخَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ أَكْبَرُ مِنْ خَلْقِ النَّاسِ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٥٧﴾

The creation of the heavens and the earth is far greater than the creation of humankind. But most of humankind do not know it (40: 57).



Environmental Approach of Hadith/Sunnah

Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) left a noble example of being eco-friendly and going green in his life. He spent his entire life in an eco-friendly effort, helping humankind, caring for other creatures of God, preserving the earth, planting trees and protecting the environment. Right from his young age, he was inclined towards preservation of trees. When he was just 12, he travelled to Syria with his uncle and took shelter under a tree. Today, after more than 14 hundred years, the same tree is still alive in the northern deserts of Jordan. This tree, which sheltered the Prophet, is the only living tree in hundreds of square miles of emptiness. It speaks eloquently of the Prophet's utmost care for the preservation of trees.

- The Prophet was keen on planting trees and exhorted his Companions, too, to do so.

He said, “Whoever plants a tree and diligently looks after it until it matures and bears fruit is rewarded” (Source: *Musnad*).

This saying is sufficient to apprise us of the eco-friendly nature of Islam. Planting a tree is a *sadaqah jariyah* (continued charity) in Islam, for the poor and the rich alike. Whenever a human being or even an animal shelters under the shade of a tree or relishes a fruit that it produces, the planter will earn rewards, even after his or her death.

- There are more such beautiful traditions of the Prophet that serve as gentle reminders for us to reflect on Islam as an environment-friendly faith. These traditions exhort us to care for all creatures, to protect the environment, to conserve water, to preserve the nature and to care for all living beings, including trees and animals.

- Considering tree-planting a renewable source of reward, the Prophet said: “If a Muslim plants a tree or sows seeds, and then a bird, or a person or an animal eats from it, it is regarded as a charitable gift (*sadaqah*) for him.” (*Bukhari*)

One day Prophet (s.a.w.) passed by Sa`d ibn Abi Waqas (r.a) while he was performing *wudu*'. The Prophet (saw) asked Sa`d: "What is this wastage?" Sa`d replied: "Is there wastage in *wudu* also?" The Prophet said, "Yes, even if you are at a flowing river." (*Ibn Majah*)

Subhanallah!!!

Subhanallah!!!

Subhanallah!!!

- Likening a believer with a growing tree, the Prophet (s.a.w.) said: “The example of a believer is that of a fresh tender plant; from whatever direction the wind comes, it bends it, but when the wind quietens down, the plant becomes straight again...”
(*Bukhari*)

- Reminding Muslims of how important it is to keep the environment sanitary to maintain the community, the Prophet (s.a.w.) stated: “Beware of the three acts that cause you to be cursed: First, relieving yourselves in shaded places (that people utilise), in a walkway or in a watering place.....”
- Similarly, the Prophet (saw) gave paramount importance to street clean-ups, when he said: “Removing harmful things from the road is an act of charity (*sadaqah*).” (Narrated by Abu Dharr Al-Ghafari, *Riyadh As Saliheen*)



Environmental Sustainability in Islam

- Islamic beliefs, traditions and values provide an effective and comprehensive solution to the current environmental challenges faced by the human race. Islam has a rich tradition of highlighting the importance of environmental protection and conservation of natural resources.

- The Holy Qur'an and Sunnah are a guiding light to promote **sustainable development**. According to Islamic law, the basic elements of nature – land, water, fire, forest, and light – belong to all living things, not just human beings.

Allah (Subhanahu Wa Ta'ala) commands human beings to avoid doing mischief and wasting resources as these acts cause degradation of the environment. The privilege to exploit natural resources was given to the mankind on a guardianship basis, which implies the right to use another person's property on the promise that it will not be damaged or destroyed.



Environment Protection and Resource Conservation

The **Islamic perspective** on environment protection reflects a positive image about Islam and how it embraces every single matter the humans face on earth. The Islamic attitude towards environment and natural resource conservation is not only based on prohibition of over-exploitation but also on **sustainable development**.

Lets talk about UNSDs.



The Holy Quran says about Environment Protection and Resource Conservation:

وَهُوَ الَّذِي جَعَلَكُمْ خَلَائِفَ الْأَرْضِ وَرَفَعَ بَعْضَكُمْ فَوْقَ بَعْضٍ دَرَجَاتٍ لِّيَبْلُوَكُمْ فِي مَا آتَاكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ رَبَّكَ سَرِيعُ الْعِقَابِ وَإِنَّهُ لَغَفُورٌ رَّحِيمٌ ﴿١٦٥﴾

“And it is He who has made you **successors upon the earth** and has raised some of you above others in degrees [of rank] that He **may try you through what He has given you**. Indeed, your Lord is swift in penalty; but indeed, He is Forgiving and Merciful.” (Surah 6:165)

The Holy Quran says about Environment Protection and Resource Conservation:

“O children of Adam! ... eat and drink: but waste not by excess, for Allah loves not the wasters.” (Surah 7:31)

Prophet Muhammad (SAW) encouraged the planting of trees and the cultivation of agriculture which are considered as good acts. This is illustrated in the following traditions:

Narrated by Anas bin Malik (RA) that Allah's Messenger (SAW) said: "There is none amongst the Muslims who plants a tree or sows seeds, and then a bird, or a person or an animal eats from it, but is regarded as a charitable gift for him."
(Bukhari).



The approach of Islam towards the use of natural resources

The approach of Islam towards the use of natural resources was brilliantly put forward by the Fourth Caliph Hazrat Ali ibn Abi-Talib (RA) who said:

“Partake of it gladly so long as you are the benefactor, not a despoiler; a cultivator, not a destroyer. All human beings as well as animals and wildlife enjoy the right to share Earth’s resources. Man’s abuse of any resource is prohibited as the juristic principle says ‘What leads to the prohibited is itself prohibited’.

When Abu Musa (RA) was sent to Al-Basrah as the new governor, he addressed the people saying:

“I was sent to you by ‘Umar ibn Al-Khattab (RA) in order to teach you the Book of your Lord [i.e. the Qur’an], the Sunnah [of your Prophet], and to clean your streets.”

- Abu Hurairah reported that the Messenger of Allah (Peace Be Upon Him) forbade that a person relieve himself in a water source or on a path or in a place of shade or in the burrow of a leaving creature.

These values highlight Islam’s stress on avoiding pollution of critical resources and importance of cleanliness.

Islam is against the cutting or destruction of plants and trees unnecessarily as is evident in the following Hadith: Abdullah ibn Habashi reported that Prophet Muhammad (SAW) said: “He who cuts a lote-tree [without justification], Allah will send him to Hellfire.” (Abu Dawud).

The lote-tree grows in the desert and is very much needed in an area which has scarce vegetation. The devastation caused by deforestation in many countries causes soil erosion and kills many of the biodiversity of the earth.



وَلَا تَمْشِ فِي الْأَرْضِ مَرَحًا إِنَّكَ لَنْ تَخْرِقَ
الْأَرْضَ وَلَنْ تَبْلُغَ الْجِبَالَ طُولًا

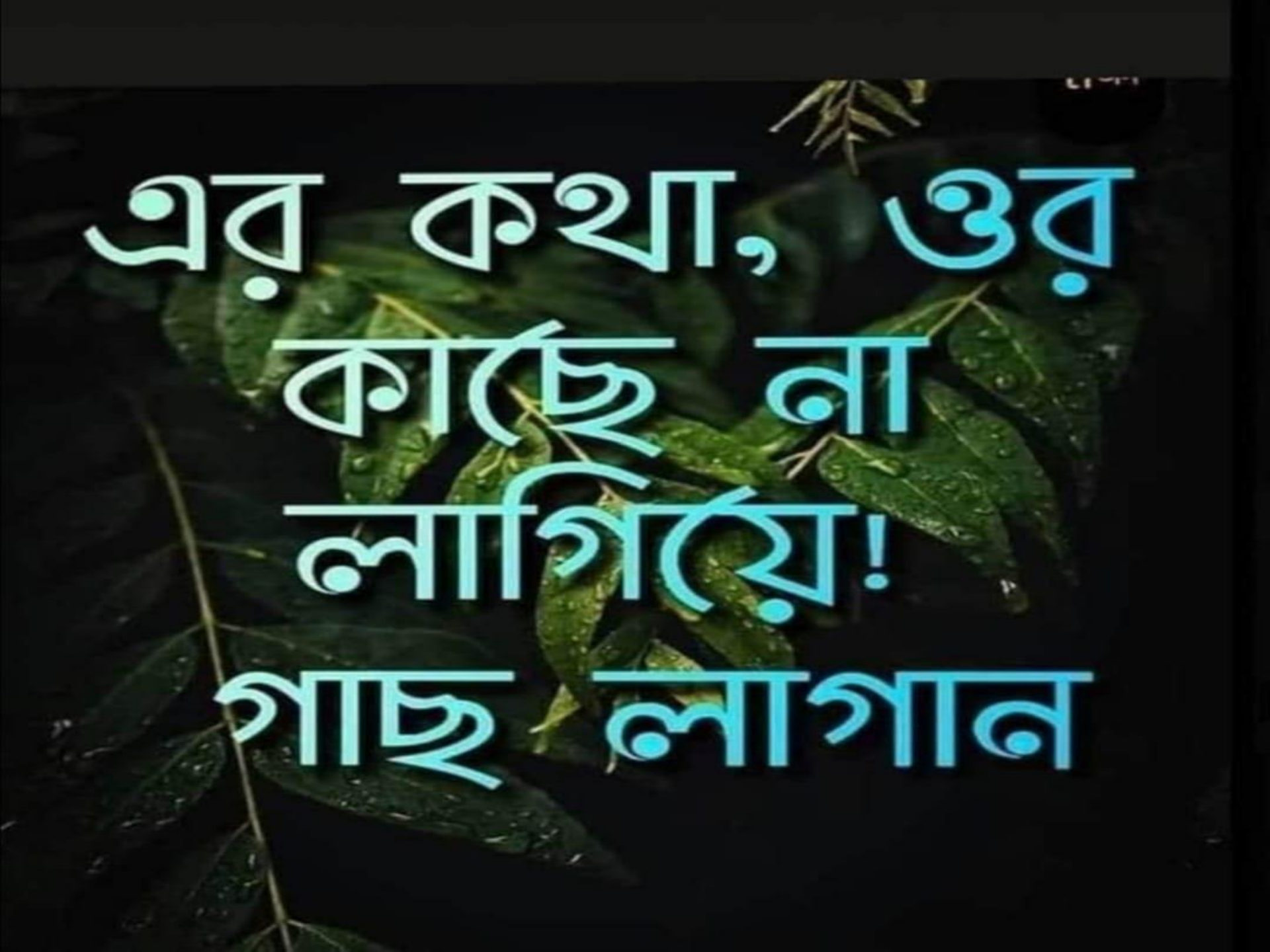
**Do not walk proudly on the earth;
your feet cannot tear apart the earth
nor are you as tall as the mountains.**



Spreading Environmental Awareness

There are various ways which you can raise environmental awareness in your personal and professional circles. The popularization of social networking among young generation makes it easier and attractive to spread environmental awareness using Facebook, Twitter, Google+ etc.

A great idea would be to start your own school, college or workplace campaign for planting trees. Students, faculty members and co-workers can be motivated to donate a nominal amount of money towards plantation campaign. Keeping plants around your home, school or workplace is not only aesthetic and decorative but also keep you healthy and improve indoor air quality.



এব কথ্য, ওব
কাছে না
লাগিয়ে!
গাছ লাগান

According to Hazrat Jabir (RA) reported that Prophet Muhammad [S.A.W] said: “No Muslim, who plants a shoot, except that whatever is eaten or stolen from it, or anyone obtains the least thing from it, is considered [like paying] alms giving on his behalf until the Day of Judgement.”
(Muslim)

Protection of environment is the duty of
every Muslim

God has created everything in this universe in due proportion and measure both quantitatively and qualitatively. God has declared in the Qur'an:

“Verily, all things have We created by measure” (Qur'an 54:49)

“...Everything to Him is measured.” (Qur'an 13:8)

“And We have produced therein everything in balance.” (Qur'an 55:7)

In the universe there is enormous diversity and variety of form and function. The universe and its various elements fulfill human welfare and are evidence of the Creator's greatness; He it is Who determines and ordains all things, and there is not a thing He has created but celebrates and declares His praise.

“Have you not seen that God is glorified by all in the heavens and on the earth — such as the birds with wings outspread? Each knows its worship and glorification, and God is aware of what they do.” (Qur'an 24:41)

God says:

“We have not created the heavens and the earth and all that is between them carelessly. We have not created them but for truth.” (Qur’an 44:38-39)

Thus, the Islamic vision revealed in the Qur’an is of a universe imbued with value. All things in the universe are created to serve the One Lord Who sustains them all by means of one another, and Who controls the miraculous cycles of life and death:

“God it is that splits the seed and the date stone, brings the living from the dead and the dead from the living: That is your God — how are you turned away?” (Qur’an 6:95)

The Prophet declared said: “The world is beautiful and verdant, and verily God, be He exalted, has made you His stewards in it, and He sees how you acquit yourselves.” (Saheeh Muslim)

All of the resources upon which life depends have been created by God as a trust in our care. He has ordained sustenance for all people and for all living beings.

“And He has set within it mountains standing firm, and blessed it, and ordained in it its diverse sustenance in four days, alike for all that seek.” (Qur’an 41:10)

Thus, in Islam the utilization of these resources is the right and privilege of all people and all species. Hence, man should take every precaution to ensure the interests and rights of all others since they are equal partners on earth.



Conclusion:

Environmental awareness and protection of natural resources is an integral part of Islamic beliefs. As viceroys of Allah on this earth, we have to utilize natural resources in a sustainable manner in order to ensure that Allah's Bounties to continue. The principle of conservation is **beautifully illustrated** by the rule which says that while making ablutions (wudu) we should be abstemious in the use of water even if we have a river at our disposal.

- As humans, we are keepers of all creation, including soil, air, water, animals and trees. A major objective of Islamic teachings and Prophet (Peace Be Upon Him) traditions is to build and maintain a **healthy and clean environment** which is devoid of any source of pollution and misuse.

Summary

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Reference

Environmental protection in Islam

by Al Glenid, Mohamed Al Sayyed, Al Sabbagh, Abdul Latif Tawfik El Shirazy, Ba Kader, Abou Bakr Ahmed, Izzidien, Mouel Yousef Samarraï, Llewellyn, Othman Abd-ar-Rahman.

- **Published by – IUCN**

- **Publication Year:**

- 1994

- **Publication ID:**

- 6989

- **Monographic series:**

- 36690

Link

<https://portals.iucn.org/library/sites/library/files/documents/EPLP-020-rev.pdf>



Feel free to ask me anything.

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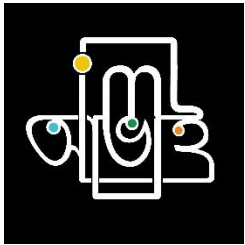
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